

KEEPING FUND SECRET

No Further News Regarding Miss Stone's Ransom.

REQUEST BY STATE DEPARTMENT

Not Considered Advisable to Make Public Announcement of Contributions—Missionaries Endeavoring to Get in Communication with Brigands to Agree Upon Amount of Ransom—Approach of Troops Induced Captors to Change Line of Retreat.

Boston, Oct. 12.—Kidder, Peabody & Co., who are handling the funds for Miss Stone's ransom, said to-day that they would be unable to make public anything concerning the amount of money in their hands, in spite of the new appeal for contributions from the United States government.

In speaking of the ransom to-day, Rev. John Smith said: "In my judgment, the only safe way to act is to have all the money demanded by the brigands as a ransom on hand in Turkey at the earliest practicable moment."

Constantine, Oct. 12.—News in the case of Miss Stone to-night is that Miss Stone's ransom is still being tried to get in touch with the brigands in order to agree on the amount of the ransom. It is scarcely likely that this agreement will be reached for some days. As soon as word comes from the brigands that the amount of the ransom has been determined upon a member of the United States Legation will start for the place named with the money.

Brigands Have Changed Base. Since the brigands who abducted Miss Stone were located on the Mountain of Gultepe the approach of the troops induced them to change their base. They are now hiding on the Turkish-Bulgarian frontier, ready to cross to either side as circumstances demand.

The decision to suspend the movements of the troops was partially due to the difficulties of operating in the mountainous country and partly owing to fear that a further advance might endanger the life of Miss Stone. Hence the American desire to try and negotiate for the payment of a ransom. It is hoped this will result in the release of Miss Stone in a few days. The officials of the United States Legation are much gratified at the Russian action in the matter. The Russian Ambassador, I. A. Zinovieff, is supporting the American demand for the ransom. The secretary of the United States Legation, Spencer Eddy, in every way possible.

Indignant Protest from Bulgaria.

Sofia, Bulgaria, Oct. 12.—An official communication, which has just been issued here, indignantly protests against the assertion that the Bulgarian government has been conspiring with the Macedonian committee, regarding the abduction of Miss Stone. The note points out that while nothing is positively known of the composition of the brigand band, it is known that it is composed of Turkish, Bulgarian, and Macedonian elements. It is stated that the Bulgarian government has no interest in the ransom, and that the Bulgarian government has no interest in the ransom, and that the Bulgarian government has no interest in the ransom.

COMPANY C'S WOUNDED.

Gen. Chaffee Forwarded List of Those Who Suffered in Battle. The following list of names of soldiers of Company C, Ninth Infantry, wounded at the Balangiga fight: Maria, Oct. 12.

Adjutant General, Washington.

Engagement Balangiga, Samar, September 25. Wounded—Company C, Ninth Infantry, Corps James Pickett, wounded in abdomen, serious; James Glass, wounded in back, slight; Sergeant John D. Clonson, spear, ear, severe; Albert B. Keller, hip, severe; Charles F. Mark, wounded in arm, moderate; William L. Gumb, moderate; Charles W. Walsh, wounded in chest, slight; Corp. Arnold Irish, wounded in shoulder, moderate; Elbert B. Le Gradenier, arm, severe; Clifford N. Humber, eye, slight; Sergt. Frank Beck, wounded in head, slight; Joseph C. Smith, wounded in head, slight; Richard Condit, elbow, slight; Corp. George Burke, eye, slight; George Allen, finger, slight; all will recover.

Comed from wounds received in action—October 2. Corp. F. Donahoe. CHAFFEE.

VILLAGE TERRORIZED BY BURGLARS.

Captured Night Watchman and Used Him as Shield Against Burglars.

Detroit, Mich., Oct. 12.—A special from Saginaw, Mich., says: Early this morning burglars, who had previously blown open the safe in the office of the United States Marshal, Company B, Saginaw, Mich., entered in force and seized in checks, terrorized the inhabitants of the village of Fosters, near here.

They captured Night Watchman Jones, bound and gagged him. Then they took him to Harden's hardware store, where they blew open the safe. Unable to open the strong box, they made the watchman open it for them. They then entered the store and opened the cash drawer of the safe.

Harden was prepared for them and opened fire. The burglars used the watchman as a shield for Harden's hardware store. Jones was shot in the hand, but none of the burglars was hit. The shooting aroused the villagers and the burglars fled.

Witch Charged with Murder.

Roseman, Mich., Oct. 12.—John Glack, a wealthy rancher, resident of Glack Valley, died last night with symptoms of morphine poisoning. His wife and hired man were under arrest, charged with the crime. Black is said to have been worth \$50,000. After eating a meal he was taken sick and died within a few hours. The suspicion of the crime was aroused and the arrests followed.

For "Old Point Comfort," Norfolk, Virginia.

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SUFFERING ON THE PENINSULA.

Venezuelan Troops Forced to Ravishing of Their Own Country.

Willemstad, Island of Curacao, Oct. 12.—Advices received here today from Caracas indicate that the Venezuelan troops are being compelled to live on the country, and take possession of everything in sight. The country is rapidly becoming deserted, resulting in a lack of food supplies of any kind and a consequent increase of hunger, distress, and suffering among the soldiers, who have no shelter. Sickness is spreading rapidly among them, and there have been no medical attendance or medicines.

The Guajira Indians are becoming more incensed against the Venezuelans on account of the ravaging of their country. The latter, and have shockingly mutilated over a score of Venezuelans who have fallen into their hands. These advices conclude with the statement that fighting there seems improbable.

San Juan de Porto Rico, Oct. 12.—The package of money which should have been delivered to Gen. Fribo-Tribe, the Colombian insurgent leader, who was in New York this summer, but which was brought here by mistake on a steamer in June last, was opened by the United States marshal today. Its contents were found to be \$7,172 Colombian pesos. The appraisers expressed the opinion that the coins were worthless. The last available quotation of the peso was \$2.12.

Luis Moret Munoz, who was arrested here June 4 because of his failure to deliver the package to Gen. Fribo-Tribe, is being held in the United States marshal's office. The package has been attached.

MR. CORTELYOU LEAVES CANTON.

Affairs of the Late President Found to Be in Good Shape.

Canton, Ohio, Oct. 12.—Secretary Cortelyou, who came here from the meeting of the trustees of the McKinley National Memorial Association at Cleveland, left for Washington at 10:45 o'clock to-night. He spent most of the day with Judge Day, who is investigating the matter of the late President's estate. The appraisal is practically completed, but the inventory will not be ready for some time.

Mrs. McKinley's condition has not greatly changed since Mr. Cortelyou was here last time, but such change as has occurred is for the better. The most noticeable in the active part of the day is the fact that she has been able to take in the matters of business and the affairs of the memorial.

The memorial trustees, it is understood, do not attempt to determine the form of the memorial at present, but will devote all their present energies to raising the money to build it.

PHILIPPINE COURTS-MARTIAL.

Native Scout in American Employ to Be Hanged for Murder.

Further interesting reports of court-martial trials in the Philippines were received at the War Department yesterday. At San Francisco, a native scout in American employ was sentenced to hang for the murder of a Chinese man. The case was tried at the court-martial at San Francisco.

At Manila, a native scout was sentenced to hang for the murder of a Chinese man. The case was tried at the court-martial at Manila.

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SAMPSON HAD NEWS

But He Did Not Tell Schley for Six Days.

ADMITTED BY HIS OWN OFFICER

The Session of the Court of Inquiry Yesterday Brought Out an Important Fact as to the Manner in Which Information About Cervera's Fleet Was Kept from Schley Until After He Had Left for Santiago and He Did Not Get Dispatch Until June 10.

In the Schley court of inquiry yesterday it was demonstrated that the first positive orders from Admiral Sampson to Commodore Schley to proceed direct to Santiago because it was certain that the Spanish fleet was in that harbor, were not sent until the 27th of May, although the information was in Sampson's possession on the 20th of May. These orders did not reach Commodore Schley until June 10.

Capt. Chadwick, Sampson's chief of staff, testified that he had the blockade of Cienfuegos partially in mind when he investigated against the sending of congratulations by Sampson to Schley.

Lieut. Commander Sidney A. Staunton, Sampson's assistant chief of staff, described the receipt of positive information on May 20 regarding the arrival of the Spanish fleet in Santiago harbor. The next dispatch to Schley was not sent until the evening of May 21, and then Sampson said that the squadron was "probably" at Santiago.

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blockade of Cienfuegos in mind when you protested against the sending of the congratulatory dispatch by Admiral Sampson to Commodore Schley.

Chadwick Wanted to Write Answers.

Instead of responding, Capt. Chadwick began to write hastily upon a tablet in front of him, evidently intending to see how his answer would look before he uttered it. As he commenced to read, however, Mr. Rayner objected on the ground that the witness could not read written answers.

"May I ask if you mean that I had the blockade of Cienfuegos in mind when you protested against the sending of the congratulatory dispatch by Admiral Sampson to Commodore Schley?"

"I do not mean anything of the kind," replied Mr. Rayner. "I mean did you have it in mind at all?"

Capt. Chadwick then, without reading from the slip of paper in front of him, responded: "I had it partially in mind."

Mr. Rayner gave a satisfied smile, for it will be the purpose of Schley's counsel to prove that Capt. Chadwick approved the Santiago blockade. The Navy Department prosecutors were not willing, how-

ever, to have to come to either Havana or Cienfuegos, and that, therefore, the ports of Havana and Cienfuegos would continue to be held.

The Memorandum by the Hawk. The memorandum sent by the Hawk on the evening of May 21, and which included a duplicate of dispatch No. 8, was as follows:

United States Flagship New York, Off Havana, May 21, 1898. "It is thought that the enclosed instructions will reach you by 2 o'clock. It is hoped they will enable you to leave before daylight (regarded very important), so that your direction may not be noticed, and be at Santiago a. m. May 22."

The St. Paul and Minneapolis have been ordered to scout off Santiago, and if the Spanish squadron goes westward, one is to keep touch and one is to go west and attempt to meet you; if the Spanish squadron goes east, one will keep in touch and the other go into Nicholas Mole to telegraph me at Key West. I shall be off Cay Francis, 200 miles east of Havana.

If you arrive off Santiago and no scout meets you, send a vessel to call at Nicholas Mole and get information to be left there by scout as to direction taken by Spanish fleet.

When the Judge-Advocate Appears at His Best

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ISLAND OF MYSTERY

San Nicolas, One of the Channel Islands, Pacific Coast.

LITTLE OF IT KNOWN TO WORLD

An Expedition from the University of California Will Soon Explore the Growsome Land that Is Spread Over with the Skulls and Jawbones of a Lost Race—How the Indian Inhabitants Became Extinct—"Lone Woman of San Nicolas."

Correspondence of The Washington Post.

Los Angeles, Cal., Oct. 7.—An air of mystery pervades each of the little islands in the scant archipelago off the coast of California. San Clemente Island is strewn with enormous prehistoric mortars and pestles, and here and there are numerous evidences that a giant race lived there before the Portugese navigator, Cabrillo, sailed for conquest up the coast of Alta, Cal., in 1552. Santa Catalina is indented by many strange caves, weird grottoes, where one may see remains of a race of fishers and artisans with shells. San Miguel Island has been the scene of titanic erosions by ice, water, and sand. The grotesque pillars that lift themselves above the island level, the winding caves that twist from the shores into the heart of the island and the roaring gulches and canyons all comprise a spot rich in possibilities for both scientist and dreamer. Santa Cruz Island is used as a pasturage for thousands of sheep, and it, too, is full of absorbing interest regarding extinct races of aborigines. The Smithsonian Institution scientists have gathered tons of stone, shell and bone utensils and personal ornaments from Santa Cruz. But San Nicolas Island has by far the most abundant evidences of a tribe of unusually tall and strong people who must have vanished almost in a night. Of all the California archipelago this is the most mysterious.

Notwithstanding the islands—known on

rious.

Notwithstanding the islands—known on the Pacific coast as the Channel Islands—are but thirty to fifty miles out in the blues of the ocean, they seldom are visited. Every few years an exploring expedition goes to them for a season of scientific study, but with the exception of Santa Catalina—a famous summer resort for California pleasure-seekers and anglers—a half-dozen visitors do not land at any of the islands once a year. To-day the islands remain as lonely and desolate as they did long before the first white face sailed up the coast—360 years ago. The races which occupied these islands are as much of a mystery as ever, and so far science is baffled in inquiring what sort of folk these aboriginal settlers were, how they lived, what they believed, and especially how they so suddenly and completely disappeared from the face of the earth.

The University of California, at Berkeley, is about to begin the most thorough exploration ever made of San Nicolas Island, which lies sixty miles off the coast of Ventura and Santa Barbara counties.

As far back as the memory of any person in Southern California runs hundreds of white skeletons have dotted the valleys and hillsides of San Nicolas. Strange utensils of serpentine, sandstone and steatite are found there among the human bones, and the island and its inhabitants have a history so curious that it is difficult of comprehension.

"Lone Woman of San Nicolas."

"Lone Woman of San Nicolas."

In 1835 the Franciscan padres in the Santa Barbara mission, learning that there were but sixteen of the strange and almost extinct Indian race then living there, determined to rescue them from the island. They went over in a sloop and succeeded, as they thought, in getting all on board. At the last moment an Indian woman returned for her child, and one of the frequent storms of the Channel Islands springing up, the sloop was driven away without her. The sloop went on the rocks of Point Conception and all on board were lost.

Sixteen years later Capt. George Nidever and two men went from the coast on a sloop to hunt sea otter off San Nicolas. On landing they were, like Crusoe, astonished to find human footprints in the sand. They saw no one, however, and a storm compelled them to put to sea.

It was two years thereafter that the adventurous captain, revolving in his mind the sight of the footprints in the uncanny island, determined to go and discover and bring over the lonely woman of whom he had vaguely heard. Men accompanied him, and at length they saw on the surf-beaten shore a woman with long tawny hair, dressed in a queer garb of colored bird skins, and scraping with a bone knife the blubber from a seal.

They surrounded and approached her

the blubber from a seal.

They surrounded and approached her stealthily, and although suddenly confronted, she did not appear in the least afraid, but smiled, and then, falling on her knees, prayed to the sun. The wild woman offered no objection when by signs she was made to understand that she was to go with them in the boat.

They reached Santa Barbara across the rough sea, and the first thing the Indian woman saw was Dr. S. L. Shaw, now eighty years old, and yet living there, riding a horse. She had never seen or heard of any object like it, and thought the man and horse were one, and she knelt on the shore and offered her devotions to it. Two weeks afterward the last inhabitant of rock-ribbed, tempest-tossed San Nicolas died from eating food to which she was unaccustomed, furnished by her rescuers, and the curtain fell on her race forever.

In speaking of that death at a meeting of the Southern California Medical Society the other day, Dr. Walter Lindley said that if the woman could have been spared a few years of life a story of one of the strangest races that ever lived in the southwest and that had no contamination with the whites might have been learned. The woman known as the "Lone Woman of San Nicolas" has been the subject of a score of romances and poems and food for a lot of philosophy on the Pacific Coast for years.

San Nicolas is ten miles long and four miles wide at the widest point. Its topography shows a nearly level plateau, with an elevation of 800 to 1,000 feet. Two-thirds of the surface is covered with drifting sand, and the remainder grows a species of nutritious grass and moss on which a thousand sheep find pasture. Several springs have been discovered, but their water is slightly brackish. Of late years the island is rarely visited except by sheepshearers and shell gatherers, who make annual trips in schooners, fishing smacks and Chinese junks.

A Desolate Island.

The only safe landing ground at San Nicolas is at Coral Harbor, a pretty cove formed by two sandstone arms thrust out from the main barrier of the shore. The entrance is but ¹²six or seven yards across, and the water within is placid as a lake and sufficiently deep to float a vessel of twenty tons burden. On the bleak, silvery strip of beach immense white pelicans are to be seen at almost any season of the year promenading with a stately dignity. On the approach of the dingy they spread their heavy pointed wings and vanish over the rocks. Farther up the shore of the beach there is a dilapidated shearing shed and a weather-worn shanty belonging to Chinese shell gatherers, who haunt these lonely cliffs during late summer and fall.

Nothing more desolate than the general appearance of the island can be imagined. As far as the eye can trace there are innumerable circular depressions, showing where primitive dwellings once stood. Not a vestige remains of the materials used in the construction of these rancherias. Hundreds of shell mounds are scattered about and are found to consist of astonishing numbers of mollusks, the bones of every species of fish found in the channel, skeletons of seals, sea elephants, whales, sea otter, the island fox, and various aquatic birds. Without question these animals were used for food by the tribes that once thronged these boundaries. There are also

numerous canine skeletons, several of which indicate a species of bull terrier. Judging from the immense quantities of dead land mollusks everywhere, there must have been a time when the island supported luxuriant vegetation. Of all this verdure nothing is seen to-day but a few stunted thorn bushes and now and then a cactus forlornly reaching its grotesque arms out of interminable sweeps of sand.

An examination of some of the mounds discloses all sorts of curious utensils, stone cooking pots, water ollas, mortars, pestles, drills, bone needles, and fishhooks, shell beads, charm stones, pipes, cups and a few arrow heads, spear points and swords made of bone. The absence of many weapons proves the peaceful attributes of the islanders. Small imitations of boats and fish carved from crystallized talc and serpentine also show a rudimentary knowledge of the art of sculpture. In many places conical piles of small black pebbles contrast oddly with the white land. In some instances these shells were closely packed in abalone shells. No trace is seen of the "brush pens," in which the lone woman of San Nicolas for years found her only shelter from the cutting wind and sand. Nature, ever unmindful of the individual, long since merged the superhuman efforts of this courageous life into the universal fate of an entire race. Indeed, every foot of this strange island is eloquent of the extinction of an almost unheard-of people.

A trip along the west coast of San Ni-

...quent of the extinction of an almost unheard-of people.

A trip along the west coast of San Nicolas Island over a vast extent of shell mounds sets one to wondering how it was possible for a limited population to consume such prodigious numbers of mollusks. In fact, the infinite variety of mollusca on San Nicolas is said by biologists not to be exceeded by any other known region of equal area. The shore line is of coarse sandstone, burrowed by the pounding surf into fantastic alcoves, bridges, columns, and caves. Sometimes these savage cuts form rude effigies bearing a surprising likeness to living creatures. One of the most conspicuous is the exact counterpart of the neck, breast and body of a bird with an alert, hooded head. This piece of nature's sculpturing must be forty feet long, and beheld from a distance looks quite as perfect as if fashioned by man. There are hundreds of photographs of this freak of nature sold all over California.

A Stone Forest.

Going westward from this exposed point

A Stone Forest.

Going westward from this gnawed, surf-lashed wall, the ground makes a gentle descent to a wide mesa, terminating in a steep escarpment. The atmosphere from this elevation is so deliciously clear that the eye can readily distinguish the peak tops of all the Channel Islands, several of them being forty miles away. Immediately at one's feet there stretches away a dreary desert of stupendous barrenness. A singular characteristic of the place were heaps of the bones of whales, their arrangement and packing so systematically correct as to have withstood a century's sweep of winds over this exposed point. But one human skeleton has ever been found here, its bleached, dismembered aspect in keeping with the driven desolateness of the spot. The merciless blast had piled the sand dunes all about, but spread no kindly drift over this "rough sketch of man." All around are the casts of roots of trees in the shifting sand, ranging all the way from coarse fiber to several inches in diameter. These semi-petrifications are all intact, the wind having swept them clean of the loose earth. They yield a metallic ring when tapped with a rock or shell. A still more remarkable feature of this desert is a sparse stone forest, the broken columns or trunks of trees composed of indurated sand.

At the extreme west end of the island

posed of indurated sand.

At the extreme west end of the island there is a colossal precipice 1,000 feet in height, its chasmed and slitted face softened by a luxuriant growth of emerald moss and lichens. The most gruesome of all the sights on this strange island is to be seen on the broad plateau on the south side of the Chinese camp, at Coral Harbor. Here acres of the naked sand are littered with hundreds of disjointed skeletons and present the most reckless illustration of the "ground plan" of humanity that imagination can picture. Measurements have been made by several scientists of the thigh, leg, and arm bones, and literally bushels of skulls and other parts of the human frame have been brought to Los Angeles from San Nicolas for investigation. The general opinion is that the physiques of the Indian race that swarmed over the island then were much larger than those of any civilized race of to-day, and that some of them must have been seven feet three inches tall. The skulls of this extinct tribe often measure several inches more than some of the large skulls of to-day. Many skulls found lying about on the island show that their possessors must have suffered death from a club or blunt battle ax. No one has ever yet found a skull on San Nicolas that shows marks of a bullet. There are many collar bones and shoulder blades broken and crushed, so that it is evident their owners were slain with some such instrument as a war club or boulder. Scientists say that the favorite weapon in warfare with the Aleutian savage tribes a century or more ago was a club or bludgeon, and this fact fits with the stray tradition that the Aleutian came down and completely destroyed the people on the Channel Islands about the year 1570.

HENRY G. TINSLEY.